

Curriculum Application & Student Challenges

How to Use This Module in Class

You are encouraged to pause students—either individually or the whole class—and have them check in on their breath while training. Remind them that just as a "Kiai" fortifies the body upon impact, conscious breathing can solidify them emotionally when they feel frustrated, angry, or hyper.

Student Challenges — Integrate into Training:

- Stop and notice your breath during Kata or Forms practice.
- Check your breath while performing techniques (both as the striker and as the Uke).
- Notice your breath during sparring matches.
- Use your breath to reset when you feel frustrated or tired.

Reflective Questions — Ask After Training:

- Do you notice yourself holding your breath when concentrating hard or exerting force?
- Does your breath move in rhythm with your movements, or are they fighting each other?
- When you felt upset or challenged today, were you able to use your breath to calm down?
- What happens to your focus when you give your breath some attention?

Module Summary: BREATH

Finding the Breath: Basic awareness and attention training.

Belly Breathing: Deep abdominal breathing for grounding and energy.

Box Breathing: Rhythmic breathing for stress regulation and recovery.

The Warrior's Bellows: Energizing breath to wake up the nervous system before training.

The Long Exhale: Extending the exhalation to lower heart rate and trigger recovery mode.